

Breastfeeding and HIV exposure on infant growth

CHL5222 Final Project (Group G)

HIV-exposed uninfected (CHEU/HEU) infants are children born to mothers living with HIV who did not acquire the virus themselves, while HIV-unexposed (CHU/HUU) infants are children born to mothers who do not have HIV. While CHEU infants are HIV-free, they represent a growing population facing higher risks of morbidity, mortality, and developmental challenges compared to CHU infants, often due to in utero exposure to the virus and antiretroviral therapy (ART). Researchers followed pregnant women in Kenya and tracked their children from birth to 24 months, collecting repeated weight-for-length measurements across multiple time points. We are interested in comparing growth outcomes between HIV-exposed uninfected (CHEU) infants and HIV-unexposed (CHU) infants, and how they interact with breastfeeding practices. The data dictionary is available from `hiv_data_dictionary.csv`.

Objective

To compare the growth trajectory of HIV-exposed uninfected infants and HIV-unexposed infants and whether breastfeeding modifies the relationship.